

AP Human Geography
Brecksville-Broadview Heights High School
2025-2026

MODEL CURRICULUM: LEARNING PROGRESSIONS

Topic/ Focus	General Pacing (days - weeks)	State Learning Standards (highlight power standards) - **College Board Standards	Key Vocabulary	Learning Targets (student friendly) I am learning:	Link to Assessments & Resources
AP Human Geography Course Skills	Entire year	- Concepts and Processes: Analyze geographic theories, approaches, concepts, processes, or models in theoretical and applied contexts. - Spatial Relationships: Analyze geographic patterns, relationships, and outcomes in applied contexts. - Data Analysis: Analyze and interpret quantitative geographic data represented in maps, tables, charts, graphs, satellite images, and infographics. - Source Analysis: Analyze and interpret qualitative geographic information represented in maps, images (e.g., satellite, photographs, cartoons), and landscapes. - Scale Analysis: Analyze geographic theories, approaches, concepts, processes, and models across geographic scales to explain spatial relationships.	Geographic Spatial Quantitative Qualitative Data Analysis Theoretical	- I can define spatial relationships. - I can describe and explain geographic concepts, processes, models and theories, while considering a specified context. - I can describe and explain spatial patterns, networks and relationships. - I can compare the significance of geography in different locations or at different times. - I can describe and explain patterns and trends in maps and quantitative data, while also explaining the limitations of data provided. - I can describe and explain patterns and trends in visual sources, while also explaining the limitations of visual sources provided. - I can explain spatial relationships and geographic characteristics at various scales.	https://apcentral.collegeboard.org/media/pdf/ap-human-geography-course-and-exam-description.pdf https://myap.collegeboard.org/login
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Big Ideas	Entire year	- Patterns and Spatial Organization: Spatial patterns and organization of human society are arranged according to political, historical, cultural, and economic factors - Impacts and Interactions: Complex relationships of cause and effect exist among people, their environments, and historical and contemporary actions.	Spatial Political Historical Cultural Economic Environmental	- I can analyze the significance of politics, history, culture and economics on the organization of human societies. - I can analyze the relationships between humans and the environment. - I can analyze human organizations in terms of spatiality and the impact on the environment.	https://apcentral.collegeboard.org/media/pdf/ap-human-geography-course-and-exam-description.pdf https://myap.collegeboard.org/login

		• Spatial Process and Societal Change: A spatial perspective allows for a focus on the ways phenomena are related to one another in particular places, which in turn allows for the examination of human organization and its environmental consequences.			
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Unit 1: Thinking Geographically	2 weeks	• Identify the types of maps, the types of information presented in maps, and different kinds of spatial patterns and relationships portrayed in maps. • Identify different methods of geographic data collection. • Explain the geographical effects of decisions made using geographical information. • Define major geographic concepts that illustrate spatial relationships. • Explain how major geographic concepts illustrate spatial relationships. • Define scales of analysis used by geographers. • Explain what scales of analysis reveal. • Describe different ways that geographers define regions.	Reference map Thematic map Absolute distance Relative distance Clustering Dispersal Elevation Distortion Geospatial technology Geographic Information Systems (GIS) Satellite navigation systems Remote sensing Census data Distance decay Time-space compression Sustainability Natural resources Land use Environmental determinism Environmental possibilism Data Formal region Functional region Perceptual or vernacular region Local scale National scale	• I can identify different types of maps and the information presented in them . • I am learning to identify different types of geographic data collection. • I can explain the effects of decisions made based on geographical information. • I can define major geographic concepts. • I can explain how major geographic concepts demonstrate spatial relationships. • I can define scales of analysis used by geographers. • I can explain what is revealed by scales of analysis. • I can describe the various ways geographers define regions.	https://myap.collegeboard.org/login Unit 1 progress checks and practice questions (MCQ, FRQ)

			Global scale		
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Unit 2: Population and Migration Patterns and Processes	4-5 weeks	- Identify the factors that influence the distribution of human populations at different scales. - Define methods geographers use to calculate population density. - Explain the differences between and the impact of methods used to calculate population density. - Explain how population distribution and density affect society and the environment. - Describe elements of population composition used by geographers. - Explain ways that geographers depict and analyze population composition. - Explain factors that account for contemporary and historical trends in population growth and decline. - Explain theories of population growth and decline. - Explain the intent and effects of various population and immigration policies on population size and composition. - Explain how the changing role of females has demographic consequences in different parts of the world. - Explain the causes and consequences of an aging population. - Explain how different causal factors encourage migration. - Describe types of forced and voluntary migration. - Explain historical and contemporary geographic effects of migration.	Climate Landforms Water bodies Culture Economics History Politics Population distribution Arithmetic population density Physiological population density Agricultural population density Population distribution Age structure Sex ration Population pyramids Markets Demographics Fertility Mortality Migration Population-doubling time Contemporary Demographic transition model Epidemiological transition	- I can identify what influences the distribution of human populations. - I can define different methods geographers use to calculate population density. - I can explain how population distribution and density can impact society and the environment. - I can describe aspects of population composition. - I can explain how geographers depict and analyze population composition. - I can explain what accounts for contemporary and historical trends in population growth and decline. - I can explain theories of population growth and decline. - I can explain the intention behind and effects of population and immigration policies on population size and composition. - I can explain the demographic consequences of the changing roles of females in different parts of the world. - I can explain the causes and consequences of an aging population. - I can explain how different factors encourage migration. - I can describe types of forced and voluntary migration. - I am learning to explain historical and contemporary geographic effects of migration.	https://myap.collegeboard.org/login Unit 2 progress checks and practice questions (MCQ, FRQ)

			Malthusian theory Pronatalist population policy Antinatalist population policy Immigration population policy Contraception Ravenstein's laws of migration Dependency ratio Life expectancy Push factor Pull factor Intervening opportunities Intervening obstacles Slavery Refugee Asylum seeker Transnational migration Transhumance migration Internal migration Chain migration Step migration Guest worker migration Rural-to-urban migration		
Topic/ Focus	General Pacing (days - weeks)	State Learning Standards (highlight power standards)	Key Vocabulary	Learning Targets (student friendly) I am learning:	Link to Assessments & Resources

Unit 3: Cultural Patterns and Processes	4-5 weeks	- Define the characteristics, attitude, and traits that influence geographers when they study culture. - Describe the characteristics of cultural landscapes - Explain how landscape features and land resource use reflect cultural beliefs and identities. - Explain patterns and landscapes of language, religion, ethnicity, and gender. - Explain how historical processes impact current cultural patterns. - Explain what factors lead to the diffusion of universalizing and ethnic religions. - Explain how the process of diffusion results in changes to the cultural landscape.	Shared practices Cultural traits Cultural relativism Ethnocentrism Cultural landscapes Linguistic characteristics Sequent occupancy Traditional architecture Postmodern architecture Gender Ethnicity Ethnic neighborhoods Indigenous communities Cultural landscapes Placemaking Centripetal force Centrifugal force Creolization Lingua franca Colonialism Imperialism Urbanization Globalization Socially constructed Communication technologies Internet Time-space convergence Cultural convergence Cultural divergence Dialects World religions Diffusion Cultural hearth	- I can define the characteristics, attitude and traits that influence geographers when they study culture. - I can describe cultural landscapes. - I can explain how landscape features and resource use reflect culture. - I can explain patterns and landscapes of language, religion, ethnicity, and gender. - I can explain how historical processes impact current cultural patterns. - I can explain factors that lead to diffusion of religions. - I can explain how diffusion changes cultural landscapes.	https://myap.collegeboard.org/login Unit 3 progress checks and practice questions (MCQ, FRQ)
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			Indo-European Toponyms Christianity Buddhism Islam Sikhism Hinduism Judaism Universal religion Ethnic religion Acculturation Assimilation Syncretism multiculturalism		
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Unit 4: Political Patterns and processes)	4-5 weeks	- Define the different types of political entities in world political maps - Identify a contemporary example of political entities from a world political map. - Explain the processes that have shaped contemporary political geography. - Describe the concepts of political power and territoriality as used by geographers. - Define types of political boundaries used by geographers. - Explain the nature and function of international and internal boundaries. - Define federal and unitary states. - Explain how federal and unitary states affect spatial organization. - Define factors that lead to the devolution of states. - Explain how political, economic, cultural, and technological changes challenge state sovereignty. - Explain how the concepts of centrifugal and centripetal forces apply at the state scale.	Nations Nation-states Stateless nations Multinational states Multistate nations Autonomous region Semi Autonomous region American Indian reservations Sovereignty Self-determination Independence movements Devolution Neocolonialism Shatterbelts Choke points Territoriality Relic boundary	- I can define types of political entities in world political maps. - I can identify modern examples of political entities on a map. - I can explain what has shaped modern political geography. - I can describe the concepts of political power and territoriality used by geographers. - I can explain the nature and function of international and internal boundaries. - I can define federal and unitary states. - I can explain how federal and unitary states affect spatial organization. - I can define factors that lead to the devolution of states. - I can explain how political, economic, cultural and technological changes challenge state sovereignty. - I can explain how the concepts of centrifugal and centripetal forces apply at the state scale.	https://myap.collegeboard.org/login Unit 4 progress checks and practice questions (MCQ, FRQ)

			Superimposed boundary Subsequent boundary Antecedent boundary Geometric boundary Consequent boundary Demilitarized zones Land boundaries Maritime boundaries UN Convention on the Law of the Sea International waters Exclusive economic zones Voting districts Redistricting Gerrymandering Unitary state Federal state Centralized governance Ethnic separatism Ethnic cleansing Terrorism Irredentism Supranationalism Economies of scale UN NATO EU ASEAN Arctic Council African Union Democratization Ethnonationalism		
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Topic/ Focus	General Pacing (days - weeks)	State Learning Standards (highlight power standards)	Key Vocabulary	Learning Targets (student friendly) I am learning:	Link to Assessments & Resources
Unit 5: Agriculture and Rural Land-Use Patterns and Processes	4-5 weeks	- Explain the connection between physical geography and agricultural practices. - Identify different rural settlement patterns and methods of surveying rural settlements. - Identify major centers of domestication of plants and animals - Explain how plants and animals diffused globally. - Explain the advances and impacts of the second agricultural revolution. - Explain the consequences of the Green Revolution on food supply and the environment in the developing world. - Explain how economic forces influence agricultural practices. - Describe how the von Thunen model is used to explain patterns of agricultural production at various scales. - Explain the interdependence among regions of agricultural production and consumption. - Explain how agricultural practices have environmental and societal consequences. - Explain challenges and debates related to the changing nature of contemporary agriculture and food-production practices. - Explain geographic variations in female roles in food production and consumption.	Market gardening Plantation agriculture Mixed crop/livestock systems Shifting cultivation Nomadic herding Ranching Clustered settlement patterns Dispersed settlement patterns Linear settlement patterns Rural survey Metes and bounds Township and range Long lot Domestication Columbian exchange Green Revolution Mechanized farming Subsistence farming Bid-rent theory Complex commodity changes Von Thunen model Interdependence Infrastructure Desertification Soil salinization Conservation	- I can explain the connection between physical geography and agricultural practices. - I can identify different rural settlement patterns and methods of surveying them. - I can identify major centers of domestication of plants and animals. - I can explain how plants and animals spread globally. - I can explain the advances and impacts of the second agricultural revolution. - I can explain the consequences of the Green Revolution on food supply and the environment in the developing world. - I can explain how economic forces influence agricultural practices. - I can describe the von Thunen model and how it is used to explain patterns of agricultural production. - I can explain the interdependence among regions of agricultural production and consumption. - I can explain how agricultural practices have environmental and societal consequences. - I can explain challenges and debates related to the changing nature of modern agriculture and food-production practices. - I can explain geographic variations in female roles in food production and consumption.	https://myap.collegeboard.org/login Unit 5 progress checks and practice questions (MCQ, FRQ)

			Irrigation Deforestation Slash and burn Terracing Draining wetlands Biotechnology Genetically modified organisms Pesticides Fertilizers Community-supported agriculture Production Consumption Value-added specialty crops Local-food movements Food-production practices		
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Unit 6: Cities and Urban Land-Use Patterns and Processes	4-5 weeks	- Explain the processes that initiate and drive urbanization and suburbanization. - Explain how cities embody processes of globalization. - Identify the different urban concepts such as hierarchy, interdependence, relative size, and spacing that are useful for explaining the distribution, size and interaction of cities. - Explain the internal structure of cities using various models and theories. - Explain how low-, medium-, and high-density housing characteristics represent different patterns of residential land use. - Explain how a city's infrastructure relates to local politics, society, and the environment. - Identify the different urban design initiatives and practices. - Explain the effects of different urban design initiatives and practices.	Migration Urbanization Suburbanization Megacities Metacities Globalization Rank-size rule The primate city Gravity Christaller's central place theory Burgess concentric-zone model Hoyt sector model Harris and Ullman multiple-nuclei model Galactic city model	- I can explain the processes that initiate and drive urbanization and suburbanization. - I can explain how cities embody globalization. - I can identify different urban concepts like hierarchy, interdependence, relative size, and spacing. - I can explain the internal structure of cities using various models and theories. - I can explain how low-, medium-, and high-density housing characteristics represent different patterns of residential land use. - I can explain how a city's infrastructure relates to local politics, society, and the environment. - I can identify different urban design initiatives and practices. - I can explain the effects of different urban design initiatives and practices. - I can explain how qualitative and quantitative data are used to show the causes and effects of geographic change within urban areas.	Unit 6 progress checks and practice questions (MCQ, FRQ)

		- Explain how qualitative and quantitative data are used to show the causes and effects of geographic change within urban areas. - Describe the effectiveness of different attempts to address urban sustainability challenges.	Bid-rent theory Cycle of development Sustainable designs Walkability Smart-growth policies New Urbanism Slow-growth cities De facto segregation Quantitative data Qualitative data Housing discrimination Redlining Blockbusting Affordability Environmental injustice Disamenity zones Zones of abandonment Inclusionary zoning Gentrification Suburban sprawl Ecological footprint	I can describe the effectiveness of different attempts to address urban sustainability challenges.	
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Topic/ Focus	General Pacing (days - weeks)	State Learning Standards (highlight power standards)	Key Vocabulary	Learning Targets (student friendly) I am learning:	Link to Assessments & Resources
Unit 7: Industrial and Economic Development Patterns and Processes	4-5 weeks	- Explain how the Industrial Revolution facilitated the growth and diffusion of industrialization. - Explain the spatial patterns of industrial production and development. - Describe social and economic measures of development.	Raw materials Colonialism Imperialism Natural resources Primary economic sector	- I can explain how the Industrial Revolution facilitated the growth and diffusion of industrialization. - I can explain the spatial patterns of industrial production and development. - I can describe social and economic measures of development.	Unit 7 progress checks and practice questions (MCQ, FRQ)

		• Explain how and to what extent changes in economic development have contributed to gender parity. • Explain different theories of economic and social development. • Explain causes and geographic consequences of recent economic changes such as the increase in international trade deindustrialization, and growing interdependence in the world economy. • Explain how sustainability principles relate to and impact industrialization and spatial development.	Tertiary economic sector Quaternary economic sector Quinary economic sector Break-of-bulk point Least cost theory Gross Domestic Product (GDP) Gross National Product (GNP) Gross National Income (GNI) Income distribution Fertility rates Fossil fuels Renewable energy Gender Inequality Index (GII) Human Development Index (HDI) Microloans Rostow's Stages of Economic Growth Wallerstein's World System Theory Dependency theory Commodity dependence Gender parity Neoliberal policies Free trade agreements European Union (EU) World Trade Organization (WTO) Mercosur Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC)	• I can explain how and to what extent changes in economic development have contributed to gender parity. • I can explain different theories of economic and social development. • I can explain the causes and geographic consequences of recent economic changes like deindustrialization or the growing interdependence in the world economy. • I can explain how sustainability principles relate to and impact industrialization and spatial development.	
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			Tariffs International Monetary Fund Microlending Outsourcing Free-trade zones Division of labor post-Fordist methods Economies of scale Agglomeration Just-in-time delivery Growth poles Natural resource depletion Pollution Climate change Ecotourism		